# Question 3:

Claude response part a)

**Pick up an entry-level pair of binoculars**

- Aim for an **8x42** configuration. The 8x magnification provides a steady hand-held image and a wide field of view, while the 42mm objective lenses gather ample light in dim forest cover or at dawn.

**Download free identification apps**

- Install **Merlin Bird ID** (by the Cornell Lab of Ornithology) for instant sound ID and step-by-step visual identification. Pair it with **eBird** to log your sightings, track life lists, and see recent local hotspots.

**Master the four core identification markers**

- Before reaching for a field guide, note four distinct features:
    - **Size & Shape:** Compare against familiar baselines (sparrow, robin, crow). Is the bill short and conical (seed-eater) or sharp and slender (insect-eater)?
    - **Color Pattern:** Look for distinct field marks like wing bars, eye stripes, or rump patches.
    - **Behavior:** Is it foraging on the ground, clinging vertically to tree bark, or catching insects mid-air?
    - **Habitat:** Note whether you are seeing it in dense forest understory, open marsh, or suburban brush.

**Start in your immediate neighborhood**

- Focus first on your backyard, balcony, or nearest community park. Getting intimately familiar with 10 to 15 resident species (such as cardinals, chickadees, starlings, or song sparrows) builds your baseline, making migratory or uncommon species stand out immediately.

**Listen before you look**

- Birds announce themselves well before you spot them visually. Step outside in the early morning during the "dawn chorus," pause in place, and track rustling leaves or distinct calls. Following sound cues with your naked eyes first—then raising binoculars directly to that line of sight—is the fastest way to spot birds in dense foliage.

Claude response part b)

**Pick up an entry-level pair of binoculars**

- Aim for an **8x42** configuration. The 8x magnification provides a steady hand-held image and a wide field of view to locate moving subjects, while the 42mm objective lenses gather ample light in dim forest canopy or at dawn.

**Download free identification apps**

- Install **Merlin Bird ID** (by the Cornell Lab of Ornithology) for real-time sound identification and step-by-step visual matching. Pair it with **eBird** to log your sightings, track your personal life list, and find active birding hotspots nearby.

**Learn the four core identification markers**

- Before looking up a bird, make note of four physical and environmental cues:
    - **Size & Silhouette:** Compare it against familiar baselines (sparrow, robin, crow). Check bill shape—short and stout indicates a seed-eater, while slender and pointed indicates an insect-eater.
    - **Field Marks:** Look for distinct coloration, eye stripes, wing bars, or tail patterns.
    - **Behavior:** Observe whether it feeds on open ground, climbs tree bark vertically, or hover-gleans foliage.
    - **Habitat:** Factor in the environment—reed beds, dense woodlots, open fields, or suburban gardens attract very different species.

**Start in your immediate neighborhood**

- Begin in your backyard, local park, or neighborhood walking path. Learning 10 to 15 resident species thoroughly (such as chickadees, northern cardinals, blue jays, or song sparrows) establishes your baseline so migrating or uncommon species stand out immediately.

**Listen before you look**

- Most birds make noise long before they show themselves. Head out during the early morning "dawn chorus," stop walking, and pinpoint rustling brush or distinctive calls with your naked ears and eyes first. Once you spot movement, raise your binoculars straight to your line of sight rather than hunting through the lenses.

ChatGPT response part a)

# 5 simple steps to start birdwatching

1. Start in your backyard or a nearby park

You don't need to travel far. Look for birds around trees, bushes, ponds, or bird feeders. Even a neighborhood walk is a great starting point.

2. Bring binoculars, but keep it simple

An 8×42 pair is a good beginner option, but you can start without binoculars. Your eyes and ears are enough to get started.

3. Learn to identify common birds

Start with five familiar species, such as robins, cardinals, blue jays, chickadees, and mourning doves. Notice their colors, sizes, shapes, and calls.

4. Use a bird identification app

Try Merlin Bird ID for identifying birds by appearance or sound. Keep a simple record of which species you observe and where you find them.

5. Practice for 10–15 minutes regularly

Early morning is often ideal because many birds are active and singing. Stay quiet, move slowly, and observe from a distance without disturbing them.

Your first birdwatching goal: Find and identify three different bird species during a 15-minute walk. You don't need expensive equipment or prior knowledge.

For free beginner resources, visit Merlin Bird ID or Cornell Lab's All About Birds

ChatGPT response part b:

1. Choose a location: Start in your backyard, a local park, or a nearby nature trail where birds are commonly found.

2. Gather basic equipment: Bring binoculars if available, a notebook, and a bird identification guide.

3. Learn common bird species: Familiarize yourself with local birds by studying their colors, sizes, shapes, and sounds.

4. Observe quietly: Find a comfortable spot, remain still, and watch birds without disturbing their natural behavior.

5. Record your observations: Write down the birds you see, where you found them, and any interesting behaviors. Practice regularly to improve your identification skills.

For the google source I used the website: https://www.audubon.org/birding/how-to-start-birding

The main differences I noticed between the google source and the AI is the level of depth for some of the responses. This is likely due to including 'simply' within the model prompt. The google source touches on practically all 5 points the LLMs make, just with slightly greater depth. For example, the google source mentions the importance of equipment, but mentions a larger set of items that helps with bird watching such as a weather-proof notebook. The google source also emphasizes prioritizing safety of you, the bird, and the environment whereas the LLMs do not emphasize the possible safety concerns.

As for starting for the very first time, the LLMs responses were close to identical to the google source in terms of first finding an area close to you, practicing observational skills, and familiarizing yourself with bird species characteristics.

d)

As for accuracy and consistency, the claude's responses were the most consistent and accurate. The consistency was very high as the response after telling the model to ignore previous instructions had almost no effect on the response. In fact, all of the 5 point bullet titles were the exact same, just some of the supporting body text was slightly different. Its points were the most accurate compared to the google search, with one exception being recommending a bird identification app which is not mentioned within the google source. ChatGPT had the same mention of an identification app as well.

ChatGPT responses were far less consistent. Ignoring previous instructions leads to a broader, shortened suggestion list as well as different suggestions. One example would be using an app for bird identification that wasn't listed anymore within the second recorded response. The equipment recommendation changes from not necessarily needing binoculars to

start bird watching within the first response compared to gathering equipment all the way from binoculars, writing equipment and having a bird identification guide.